



The AI Automation Guide for Accountants

From month-end close to keeping up with regulation — hand
the repetitive work over to AI

GROWT Method

Who Is This Guide For?

This guide is for accountants, bookkeepers, tax advisors, and accounting-firm owners who live through the month-end close chaos, struggle to keep up with regulatory and tax-filing changes, and never quite find the time for the advisory work that actually grows their practice.

What's Inside This Guide?

- 3 practical scenarios — document-processing automation, keeping up with regulation, and the monthly client report
 - 5 AI tools — hand-picked for an accounting practice
 - 12 copy-paste prompts — from document classification to a tax-planning note
 - Your first 7-day checklist — step by step, to weave the system into your office
 - A before → after comparison — the concrete time you save on month-end close
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Month-end is coming: hundreds of documents, last-minute filings, clients calling. Everything at once — and no hours left for actual advisory work. AI lightens that document load, so you can focus on the value-added work only you can do.

Why AI Matters

Accounting and tax advisory are consistently named among the professions that stand to gain the most from AI — and that's an opportunity, not a threat. Processing repetitive documents, data entry, and standard reporting can all be automated with AI, freeing you up for advisory work, strategy, and client relationships. Tax and reporting rules change often, and keeping up with them — then explaining them to clients in plain language — is a job all on its own.

The Big 4 firms (Deloitte, PwC, EY, KPMG) already lean heavily on AI for document analysis and reporting. For small and mid-sized practices, the same tools are now available for free or at very low cost.

The Numbers

40%

Share of an accounting professional's time spent on data entry and document processing — AI can shrink that dramatically.

Accenture Finance Report, 2025

4x

How much faster accounting firms using AI tools produce reports — same quality, a fraction of the time.

AICPA Digital CPA Survey, 2024

78%

Small-business clients who expect more proactive advice from their accountant — AI frees up that time.

Sage SME Accounting Report, 2023

WITHOUT AI

- Hundreds of invoices and documents classified and matched by hand
- Separate hours spent tracking regulatory changes — and sometimes missing them
- Every monthly client report built from scratch, every single time
- No time left to advise clients — just the filings get done

WITH AI

- You hand the document list to AI; classification and a summary are ready in minutes
- You summarize regulatory updates with AI and send clients a ready-to-go briefing
- The monthly client report template comes back in 20 minutes; personalizing it takes 10
- The repetitive work goes to AI — you focus on advisory work and growth opportunities

Scenario 1: Scenario 1: Document Processing & Classification Automation

Problem:

A client sends over hundreds of invoices, receipts, and bank slips — every one a different format, some barely legible. Classifying them and matching them to ledger accounts takes hours. This isn't work that speeds up on its own — but AI can take a meaningful chunk of the process off your hands.

Step-by-Step

- 1 Pull the text out of the documents with an OCR tool (Google Lens, Adobe Scan, or similar)
- 2 Paste the extracted text into Claude and use the classification prompt below
- 3 AI classifies each document with a type, amount, date, and suggested account code
- 4 Review the classification, fix anything off, and import it into your accounting software
- 5 Have it draft a template message to flag missing or incorrect documents back to the client

EXAMPLE PROMPT

You are an experienced accounting professional. Classify the document list below and suggest a ledger entry for each one.

Client type: [Small business / Sole trader / Limited company / Corporation]

Period: [Month/Year]

Industry: [Sector]

Document list (one document per line):

[Document 1: OCR text or manual entry]

[Document 2: ...]

[...]

For each document, give:

1. Document type (invoice / receipt / bank slip / bank statement / contract / other)
2. Date
3. Amount (showing net and gross / tax-inclusive separately)
4. Counterparty name
5. Suggested account code (per your standard chart of accounts)
6. A note if needed (missing information, anything to watch for)

Return the output as a table. Mark anything you're unsure about as "needs review".

BEFORE

**Classifying 100 documents:
3-4 hours of manual work**

AFTER

**OCR + AI classification + re-
view: 45-60 minutes**

Scenario 2: Scenario 2: Keeping Up With Regulation & Client Briefings

Problem:

A tax rule changed, a new filing requirement was published, an e-invoicing threshold dropped. Just tracking those changes is a job — and then explaining them to clients in plain language is a second job. More often than not it's either late or under-explained.

Step-by-Step

- 1 Follow your tax authority's bulletins and the major professional bodies' updates
- 2 Give the new regulation text or a summary of it to Claude
- 3 AI produces a clear client briefing you can send out
- 4 Polish it in your firm's voice and tailor it to the client type
- 5 Use your email list to send it to all clients at once

EXAMPLE PROMPT

Turn the tax/regulatory change below into a clear client briefing.

Regulation/notice summary: [Paste the text or summarize it briefly]

Effective date: [Date]

Client types affected: [Which businesses are impacted]

Prepare a client briefing:

- Headline: attention-grabbing but not technical
- What changed: 3-4 bullet points, plain language, no jargon
- What our client needs to do: concrete steps, with dates
- Deadline warning: clear and emphasized
- A "happy to help with this" closing line

Format: email body, max 300 words, professional but accessible.

Note: add a reminder to "speak with your accountant for detailed advice specific to your situation". This is general information, not tax advice.

BEFORE

Reading the regulation + writing the client letter: 2-3 hours (for all clients)

AFTER

Regulation summary + AI letter + editing: 30-45 minutes, sent in bulk

Scenario 3: Scenario 3: The Monthly Client Financial Report

Problem:

You want to send every client a monthly financial report — but there's never time to prepare one. So it either doesn't go out at all, or it goes out far too late. The client has no idea what's been done or where things stand.

Step-by-Step

- 1 Pull the client's basic monthly figures: revenue, expenses, tax, key line items
- 2 Give those figures to Claude and use the report prompt below
- 3 AI produces a report draft — an executive summary, data for charts, recommendations
- 4 Add your own observations and any warnings
- 5 Save it as a PDF and send it to the client — once a month, 20 minutes per client

EXAMPLE PROMPT

Using the data below, prepare a client financial report summary for [Month/Year].

Client: [Company name]

Industry: [Sector]

Period: [Month/Year]

Financial data:

- Total revenue: [amount]
- Total expenses: [amount]
- Net profit/loss: [amount]
- Tax liability: [amount]
- Top 3 expense items: [list]
- Top 3 revenue items: [list]
- Change vs. last month: [+/- %]
- Bank balance (period end): [amount]
- Overdue receivables: [amount]
- Upcoming payment obligations: [date + amount]

The report should include:

1. Executive summary (3-4 sentences, non-technical language)
2. Period performance (compared with last month)
3. 2-3 financial points worth watching
4. 2 recommendations for the next period
5. Upcoming key dates (filings, tax payments, etc.)

In plain language the client will understand, with minimal accounting jargon.

BEFORE

Preparing a monthly report: 1-2 hours/client (often skipped)

AFTER

Data entry + AI draft + review: 20-25 minutes/client

Recommended AI Tools

Claude (claude.ai)

Free

The most capable AI assistant for document analysis, summarizing regulation, client letters, and reporting.

Best for: [Document classification](#), [regulation summaries](#), [client reports](#), [advisory notes](#)

ChatGPT (chatgpt.com)

Free

A solid alternative for drafting text and getting help with spreadsheet formulas.

Best for: [Spreadsheet formulas](#), [alternative report text](#), [quick Q&A](#)

Adobe Scan / Google Lens

Free

Free tools that turn paper documents into digital text with OCR — the first step before AI processing.

Best for: [Scanning invoices and receipts](#), [extracting text with OCR](#)

Notion AI (notion.so)

Paid

An AI-assisted tool for client files, task tracking, and managing your firm's internal processes.

Best for: [Client CRM](#), [task tracking](#), [internal process documentation](#)

Microsoft Copilot (Excel AI)

Paid

AI-assisted analysis inside Excel — formula generation, automatic charts, and summary reporting.

Best for: [Financial statement analysis](#), [automatic charts](#), [pivot table help](#)

Copy-Paste Prompt Pack

1. 1. Document Classification

Classify the document list below using standard accounting practice. For each document, give: document type, date, amount, counterparty, suggested account code, and a note. Return it as a table. [Paste the document list here]

Expected output: A structured document-classification table with suggested account codes

2. 2. Invoice Summary Report

Produce a summary report for this period's invoices: [invoice list]. Give net and gross totals, grouping by supplier, and the 5 largest spend items. Table plus a short comment.

Expected output: An invoice summary table and spend analysis

3. 3. Regulation Summary — Client Letter

Turn this regulatory change into a client briefing letter: [regulation text or summary]. Effective: [date]. 300 words, no technical jargon, with the client's required actions stated clearly. Add a "speak with your accountant for advice specific to your situation" reminder. General information, not tax advice.

Expected output: A ready-to-send regulatory briefing letter for clients

4. 4. Client Briefing — New Requirement

The e-invoicing threshold has been updated to [amount]. [Scope, date, exemption details]. Write a short email explaining this change to a small-business client. What they need to do now, the deadline, and what our firm will handle — clear, simple, 200 words.

Expected output: A client email explaining the new requirement

5. 5. Monthly Financial Report

Prepare a financial report for [Company name] for [Month/Year]. Revenue: [amount], Expenses: [amount], Net: [amount], Key changes: [list]. Executive summary (3 sentences), period review, 2 recommendations, upcoming key dates. Minimal technical jargon.

Expected output: A ready-to-send monthly financial report for the client

6. 6. Tax-Planning Note

Prepare a [Year] tax-planning note for a [client type and industry]. Current tax position: [summary]. Available reliefs and deductions: [if any]. Give 3 concrete action recommendations — short-term (this month), mid-term (3 months), long-term (year-end). Technical but readable. Note: general guidance, to be confirmed against the client's circumstances.

Expected output: Client-specific tax-planning action notes

7. 7. Client Advisory Recommendation

Based on this financial picture, prepare a proactive advisory recommendation for [client]: [summary financial position]. Three points: a growth opportunity, a risk warning, and an area that could be optimized. Format it for an advisory meeting — short and compelling.

Expected output: Proactive advisory notes, ready for a client meeting

8. 8. Filing Checklist

Prepare a period checklist for a [VAT / payroll / corporation tax / income tax] filing. Which documents are needed, which accounts to check, which reliefs and deductions to consider, and the deadline. For internal use, itemized, in a checkbox format.

Expected output: A filing-prep checklist, ready for internal use

9. 9. Receivables Reminder

On behalf of [client], write a reminder for an overdue receivable of [amount] from [debtor company], due [date]. First reminder: polite and professional. Second reminder: firmer, with a hint of escalation. Give both versions.

Expected output: A two-stage overdue-receivables reminder letter

10. 10. Period Close Report

Prepare a [period: month/quarter/year] close report. Data: [summary]. Close-checklist status: [done/outstanding]. Filing status: [info]. A close summary letter for the client: 200 words — what was done, the outcome, and what's next.

Expected output: A period close summary report and client letter

11. 11. Payroll / Statutory Rate Update

Notice of a change to minimum wage / statutory payroll rates: [change detail, effective date]. Write a briefing letter to send to clients who employ staff. What the employer needs to do, the impact, and the deadline — 200 words, clear and actionable.

Expected output: A payroll-rate update briefing for employer clients

12. 12. Annual Review Summary

Prepare a [Year] year-in-review summary for [client]. Data: [annual revenue, expenses, profit, tax, key developments]. The year in review, lessons learned, and 3 priority recommendations for next year. Formatted for an annual meeting presentation, 1 page.

Expected output: An annual review summary, ready for a client meeting

Your First 7 Days

One step a day. By the end of the week, you'll have seen your first results.

- ☐ **Day 1: Sign up for Claude.ai** (60 min) Take last month's client document list and run a classification test with Prompt 1. Compare the result with your current system.
- ☐ **Day 2: Turn the latest tax/regulatory change into a client letter** with Prompt 3. Send it to one client as a test and gather feedback.
- ☐ **Day 3: Generate a monthly financial report draft** for your 3 largest clients with Prompt 5. Add your own assessment and review the result.
- ☐ **Day 4: Set up Adobe Scan or Google Lens** (15 min) Test the paper-document workflow — OCR → Claude → classification.
- ☐ **Day 5: Prepare a checklist for the upcoming filing period** with Prompt 8. Fold it into your firm's standard process.
- ☐ **Day 6: Prepare and send reminder letters** with Prompt 9 for clients with overdue receivables.
- ☐ **Day 7: Review the week's AI experiments.** Which processes sped up the most? Pick the 3 prompts to add permanently to your firm's workflow.

Transform with the GROWT Method

You've handed the bulk of the repetitive work to AI and systematized your client reporting. The real opportunity now is to deepen your advisory work and grow your firm's capacity. The GROWT Method helps you manage that shift step by step — from technical processes to strategic advisory. Take the quiz at growtify.ai/test for your personal plan.

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- G** — Gap Analysis
 - R** — Roadmap
 - O** — Operationalize
 - W** — Win
 - T** — Transform

This guide gave you a starting point. With the GROWT Method's structured process, complete the full transformation across 5 levels.

growtify.ai/test → **Build your plan**

Next step: An AI Transformation Plan Built for Your Firm

You've sped up document processing and reporting. Next comes growing your client portfolio, increasing advisory revenue, and scaling your firm's operations. Take the free AI Digital Maturity Test at growtify.ai/test — a roadmap built for your firm, in 5 minutes.

Build Your Plan →

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